

ing stagnant and out-of-date ideas will hardly connect themselves with the modern free-thinking new generation.

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, *Pune*

The BJP is yet to reconcile itself to the fact that people have rejected it lock, stock and barrel, and they have given credence to this fact by voting it out in almost all states that went to elections recently. After blatantly usurping the realm of the BJP, the RSS chief has declared with all arrogance that soon a non-Delhiite would become the boss. By the time such a compromise candidate is picked up by him, the BJP itself may not be in existence to accept and adhere to his dictum.

T.S. FERNANDO, *Chennai*

Tough Turf

It is a pity that the elected Government in Karnataka has to face instability due to certain greedy elements within the party ("Thorn in the Throne", November 16). B.S. Yeddyurappa should not have allowed the crisis to snowball into a major issue and should have recommended the dissolution of the Government when his MLAs raised the banner of revolt. He should not have succumbed to the pressure tactics of the Reddy brothers and should have gone to the people for their mandate. It would have raised his stature.

Now after agreeing to the deal, Yeddyurappa cannot function independently in future and there is no guarantee that there will not be a revolt again.

R. MURALIKUMAR, *Chennai*

While Yeddyurappa cannot be free of blame for engendering a crisis in Karnataka by overpatronising a lady minister, the implications of the Reddy brothers' action should

PANKAJ TIWARI/www.indiatodaygroup.com



Providing 'red-light' cars and bungalows to an extended army of ministers is a continuation of malpractices in ministry formation in the faulty political system of India.

MADHU AGRAWAL, *Delhi*

not be overlooked as it has abetted a culture of horse trading. They are the usual 'money-power gone to the head' product of a family which has a rags-to-riches story behind it. The Government would do well to investigate the rise of the Reddys.

KRSNA KARNA, *Patna*

Asset Management

Like the dictum that justice should not only be done but should be seen to be done, judicial officers should not only be persons of integrity but must be seen to be such ("Declaring their Assets", November 16). The logic-defying delay in accepting the principle of declaration of assets has dented the perception of the higher judiciary, probably without cause but

with justification.

BISHAN SAHAI,
via www.indiatoday.in

Corrigendum

The name of high commissioner to Bangladesh Rajeet Mitter was wrongly spelt as Rajeet Mittal ("Signposts", November 16). The error is regretted.
EDITOR

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

JANUARY 16-31, 1980

The Sanjay Men

On December 24, ten days before the historic 1980 elections, Mrs Indira Gandhi declared: "Sanjay Gandhi is seeking entry into Parliament not to run the government or practice politics but to defend himself against wanton attacks on his personal reputation by the press and politicians." And two weeks later, the unassuming bespectacled younger son of Prime Minister Indira Gandhi secured the spectacular mandate from the people of Amethi in Uttar Pradesh who had rejected him barely 34 months ago. But Sanjay will not be alone to defend himself in Parliament. Riding on Indira's tidal wave which swept the poll, over 70 young loyalists of Sanjay have also been elected to

Parliament. Every fifth newly elected Congress(I) MP is personally loyal to Sanjay. Surprisingly, all of them have been elected with huge margins despite the virulent attack launched against them by the Opposition for their involvement in the Emergency excesses. *by Prabhu Chawla*

SANJAY GANDHI, KAMAL NATH
AND JAGDISH TYTLER



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